

LONDON | Pressure Tactics

Even though the perpetrators of the 26/11 Mumbai attacks have not been punished by Pakistan, the US is already mounting pressure on India to begin a dialogue with its neighbour. During Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's 30-minute meeting with US President Barack Obama at the G-20 summit in London, Manmohan was candid about Delhi's reservations on Obama's Afghanistan-Pakistan policy. Diplomatic sources say Manmohan is reported to have told Obama that there was no concept of good or moderate Taliban and that Delhi felt that the increase in US aid to Pakistan could be used in promoting terrorism against India. The US line at this meeting was trying to put the Indians back at the dialogue table with Pakistan. After 26/11, India had suspended the composite dialogue process with Pakistan. Manmohan has said that India could only



consider talking to Islamabad if it took credible steps to dismantle terror infrastructure in Pakistan. While India is not in a mood to heed Obama's advice, considering that its special interlocutor on Pakistan and Afghanistan Richard Holbrooke is visiting on April 8, the relationship may only sour if the US presses this point any further.

by Saurabh Shukla

Missing Bubbly

So what's a posh guy like you doing in a cesspool like Indian politics? Managing quite nicely. Former UN diplomat Shashi Tharoor, the Congress' celebrity candidate from Thiruvananthapuram, has settled in well to the rough life of the campaign trail. But the khadi-clad Tharoor does miss his favourite culinary crossover: idlis and coconut chutney, all washed down with a flute of champagne.

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